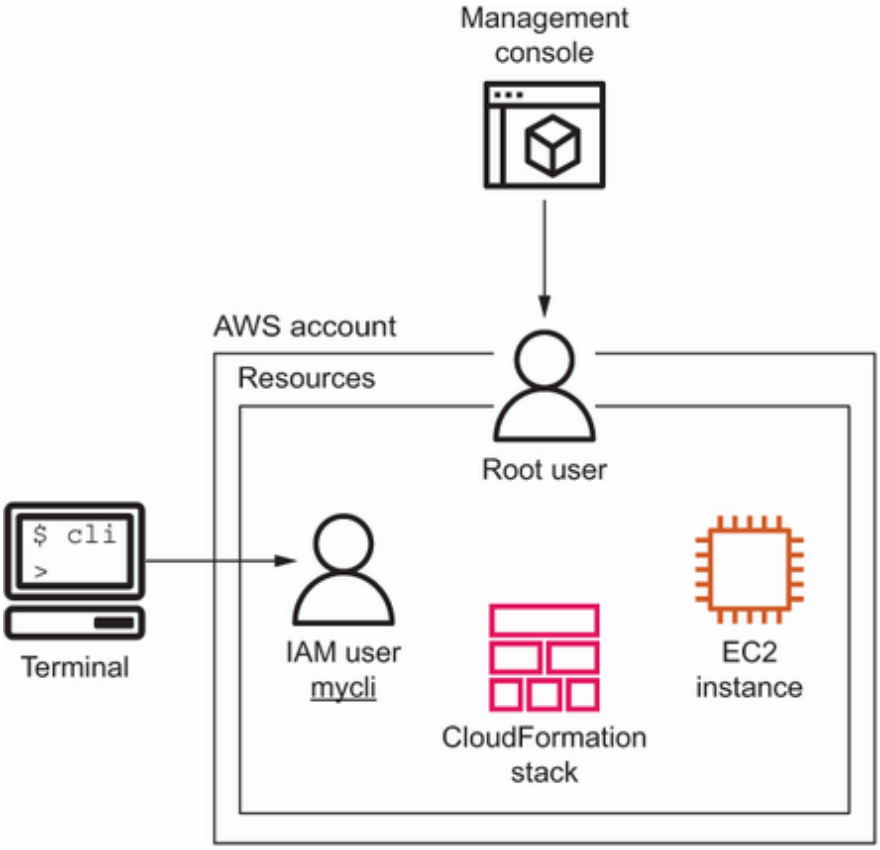



**Figure 5.4 An AWS account contains all the AWS resources and comes with an AWS account root user by default.**

To access your AWS account, an attacker must be able to authenticate to your account. There are three ways to do so: using the AWS account root user, using an IAM user, or authenticating as an AWS resource like an EC2 instance. To authenticate as a AWS account root user or IAM user, the attacker needs the username and password or the access keys. To authenticate as an AWS resource like an EC2 instance, the attacker needs access to the machine to communicate with the instance metadata service (IMDS).

To protect yourself from an attacker stealing or cracking your passwords or access keys, in the following section, you will enable